

Out of the total population temporarily living abroad, 412,735 (61.4%) were males and 259,514 (38.6%) were females. Also, of the total population temporarily living abroad, 12.8 percent were reported from the Gampaha District, 10.6 percent from the Colombo District, and 9.5 percent from the Kurunegala District, while the lowest percentage, 0.2 percent, was reported from the Mannar, Mullaitivu, and Kilinochchi Districts.

According to Figure 5.2.1, the majority of the population temporarily living abroad, accounting for 66.8 percent (449,369), belonged to the 30–59 years age group. In addition, 2.9 percent (19,383) were persons under 18 years of age, while 2.4 percent (16,124) were aged 60 years and over.

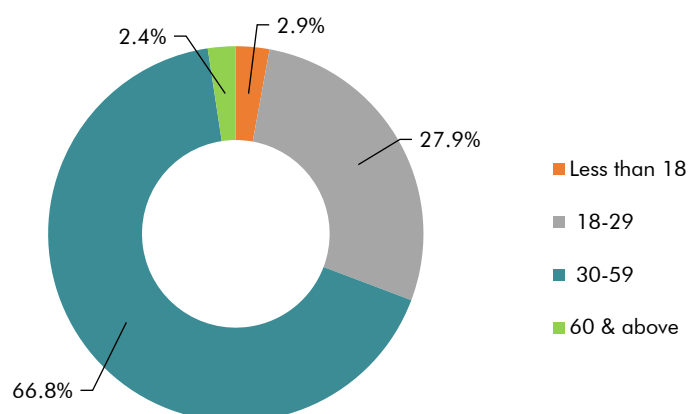


Figure 5.2.1 : Population Temporarily Living Abroad by Age Group, 2024

According to Table 5.2.2, the majority of the population reported as temporarily living abroad was from the rural sector (512,965). Furthermore, in every sector, the highest number of persons who had gone abroad belonged to the 30–59 years age group.

Table 5.2.2 : Population Temporarily Living Abroad by Sector, Sex and Age Group, 2024

Sector by Sex	Total	Age Group (Years)			
		Less than 18	18-29	30-59	60 & over
Total	672,249	19,383	187,373	449,369	16,124
Male	412,735	9,872	127,016	268,174	7,673
Female	259,514	9,511	60,357	181,195	8,451
Urban*	130,648	6,102	38,344	82,067	4,135
Male	87,781	3,054	25,809	56,438	2,480
Female	42,867	3,048	12,535	25,629	1,655
Rural	512,965	13,199	142,788	345,206	11,772
Male	318,828	6,785	99,100	207,776	5,167
Female	194,137	6,414	43,688	137,430	6,605
Estate Rural **	28,636	82	6,241	22,096	217
Male	6,126	33	2,107	3,960	26
Female	22,510	49	4,134	18,136	191

*In 2024 information was collected separately for "Urban" and "Estate Urban" sectors, for comparison with the 2012 Census data, these two sectors have been combined and presented as "Urban".

** In the 2012 Census, the sector was identified as "Estate", whereas in the 2024 Census it is referred to as "Estate Rural."